**Chapter 1: The Cradle Without Stairs and the Blank of Trauma**

Before being the "Rest", his real name was Vaelis Zandorion. He was born into a structured family, the son of Ashura Zando and Athena Orion. The first seven years of his life were peaceful and happy. Contrary to ignorant rumors from the outside world, which claim that the Shadar-kai live in isolated tents, they guard fragments of a formidable and highly developed metropolis. It was a city with a built and advanced architecture, designed specifically for a race that moves through shadows: majestic buildings, perfectly constructed, but without a single staircase, designed only for those who mastered teleportation.

But that happiness crumbled at the age of seven. The event that led to the abandonment was so violent or terrifying that Vaelis's childish mind completely blocked it out; there are no memories as it happened due to the trauma. When he "came to," Vaelis was alone, with the overwhelming feeling that his race, his family, and his people had rejected him and abandoned him to his kind. His parents' features faded from his memory, leaving only echoes of who they were.

**Chapter 2: Streets, the False Savior and Mutilation**

For months, he was adrift like a seven-year-old child, with no one, asking for theft just to have something to eat. It was in the misery of the streets that I found J.B., a human in his 40s, with an initially welcoming attitude.

J.B. he was not an adopted father; he was the master of a group of young men who trained to become ring beaters, thieves and assassins. The training was relentless, intense and severe. The rule was simple and cruel: if they messed up, you got beat up.

The dehumanization of Vaelis Zandorion began physically and psychologically at the hands of J.B.

Physical Mutilation: During one of the guild missions, the plan devised what passed for human. When the disguise threatened to fail, J.B., with brutal coldness, cut off the tips of his elven ears to force the disguise.

Death of the Name: Sometime after revealing his aristocratic surname to J.B., he spits on his inheritance. His words echoed in his head to this day: "You? Zandorion? You're just shit. Nothing... Now that you're talking about it, you're going to start being Zan, which goes against who you are." Vaelis died there; Zan was born, the rest.

**Chapter 3: The Leap of Faith and Betrayal**

He survived in J.B.'s guild until he was 11 years old, when his destiny changed forever. During a mission that went catastrophically wrong, Zan found himself trapped. The only escape route was a fatal 30-foot cliff. Consumed by despair and driven by the adrenaline of those whom death pursues closely, he jumped without thinking. Suspended in the air, I almost fell towards the end, asking for help inside.

And, in the silence of despair, "The Raven Queen answered."

It was in this moment of absolute panic that Shadar-kai's racial teleportation awakened, saving his life and allowing him to reach the other side. But this divine victory became his curse. Upon witnessing the magical "awakening", J.B. saw Zan as a valuable commodity. Over the years, he bought and sold it to Flesh Architects (Arquitetos da Carne).

**Chapter 4: The Blood Laboratory, the Stones and the Subject 241**

From the ages of 11 to 13, you experienced true hell at the hands of Flesh Architects. You went from being a street killer to a piece of meat at the mercy of sadistic scientists and unethical wizards. They were not interested in his combat skills; they wanted to dissect your race's innate connection to the Shadowfell and the moment the Raven Queen responded to you.

His identity was obliterated and derived by a number. It was just Subject 242.

The tests you were sent for did not seek to improve you, but rather to break you to understand how your biology worked. The tortures took on a terrifying clinical coldness:

The Void Drain: You were repeatedly submerged in tanks of icy alchemical fluids that simulated the Shadowfell disposable. The Architects kept you there until your lungs gave out, only to revive you at the last second, trying to measure the dark energy your body released when you were on the verge of death.

Arcane Dissection: Strapped to cold iron tables, you underwent incisions along your spine without any anesthesia. They inserted silver wires and poisoned needles directly into your nervous system, trying to "fish" and physically extract the magical reflex that made you teleport, causing spasms of pain that lasted for days.

However, the macabre turning point occurred during the Catalyst Project. Flesh Architects realized that their teleportation could not be extracted with blades, it necessarily had to be requested. They immobilized you and spread heavy and red-glowing heated stones imbued with raw magic directly on your naked skin and flesh. These stones, pulsing with unstable arcane energy, began to burn and merge with his aura. The agony was so great that his

survival instinct took over. There was no mark, tattoo or gray scar drawn on it. What happened was an internal volcanic reaction: the magic of the stones penetrated his pores and, in order not to be disintegrated by this energy, his body absorbed it, permanently changing the way his natural Shadar-kai teleportation works. That's why, today, you can resist damage when you move through the shadows—your body has learned to use desperation and intrusive energy as a shield.

But in the midst of all this darkness, all the needles and silenced screams, there was a sliver of light. You shared your "rest" moments with Sophie, Subject 241. In the short intervals of silence in the lab, you healed each other's wounds. During those two excruciating years, their shared horrors turned into an unbreakable connection, a pure and profound love born in the ugliest place on earth. Sophie was the only reason his mind hadn't completely shattered when the magic stones burned his soul.

**Chapter 5: The Escape**

During one of the experiments of the Catalyst Project, an escaping oportunity arised: Zan successfully teleported out of the chair he was bound to, accidentally killing the body guard in the room that would keep the test subjects in check. Zan then grabbed the nearby scalpel and out of pure rage stabbed the so-called scientist in the room until they were nothing more that a pile of blood, mutilated flesh and regret. Zan ran out of the room, sprinted down a hallway, made several turns - the alarm had been raised, multiple guards now chasing him. He was cornered - there was only one way out: a window that would lead to a 100 ft. drop. He made his choice - better die a free person than living as an imprisoned one. He jumped, arms flailing around - one of the rune stones that was under Zan's skin flied out. And then he felt it: the stone, the magical essence - he could use it as an anchor. A teleportation anchor. And so, like a similar time in Zan's recent past, he closed his eyes, begged for help, focused on the stone, and waited for a miracle. 1 second passed, then 3, then 8. Almost 15 second had passed, and he had not heard an answer. The fall would take around this much time to hit the ground, so if he's end was coming, he wanted to see it - he opens is eyes, expecting to see fast-approaching street floor. Instead, he sees the rooftop floor, the city landscape, the skies above him, the streel level beneath him, the building he just jumped of 40 ft. standing behind him, a single raven feather on the floor nearby, and a glimpse of hope on the horizon. Zan ran, ran and ran. Hid, stole, survived. Settled down, started working as an assassin and a bounty hunter.

Now Zan seeks to gather enough power and resources to take down the Flesh Architects, hunt down JB, put an end to the Flesh Architects and rescue Sophie (if she's still alive) from their hands.